

Claude the Octopus

Designed by Kate E Hancock



Measurements

Approximately 9 inches / 23 cm head height and 45 inches/ 115 cm across tentacle tip to tip using an Aran weight yarn

Materials

- 300g/450m of Aran weight yarn in Main Colour (Yarn A) - I used Light Blue
- 150g/225m of Aran weight yarn in Contrast Colour 1 (Yarn B) - I used White
- 60g/90m of Aran weight yarn in Contrast Colour 2 (Yarn C) - I used Orange
- 60g/90m of Aran weight yarn in Contrast Colour 3 (Yarn D) - I used Dark Blue
- 4mm (G) crochet hook
- 2 x safety eyes (I used 24mm)
- Toy filling
- Yarn needle
- Stitch markers

Design Notes

This pattern is written using US crochet terminology. You can use any yarn and appropriate hook to make this, but be aware that this will directly affect the size of the finished piece. Amigurumi need to be crocheted quite tightly to avoid the stuffing from showing through, so if you use a different weight yarn to the pattern, make sure to use a slightly smaller hook than the yarn recommends. If you are making this for a small child you should use a crochet eye version and not use safety eyes.

Abbreviations

st(s)	Stitch(es)
ch	Chain
sc	Single crochet
hdc	Half double crochet
dc	Double crochet
sl st	Slip stitch
rnd	Round
rem	Remaining
sc2tog	Single crochet 2 stitches together

* = Repeat instructions between asterisks as many times as indicated in pattern.

() = total number of stitches at the end of round.

4dcCL 4Double Cluster

Yarn over hook and insert hook into stitch drawing up a loop, yo and pull through 2 loops on hook leaving 2 loops remaining, repeat this 3 more times in same stitch (5 loops left on hook) yo and pull through all 5 loops on hook.

3dcCL 3Double Cluster

Yarn over hook and insert hook into stitch drawing up a loop, yo and pull through 2 loops on hook leaving 2 loops remaining, repeat this 2 more times in same stitch (4 loops left on hook) yo and pull through all 4 loops on hook.

[] = Repeat instructions between brackets as many times as indicated in pattern.

Pattern

This pattern involves working into chains. Make sure that your chain stitches are very loose in order to make working into them easier. In this pattern when working into the chains, you need to work into the bump on the back of the chain.

This pattern involves a colour change in the cluster stitches. **These are not stated in the pattern but you will need to change to Yarn C for every cluster (4dcCL/3dcCL) stitch. Switch back to the Yarn B for all other stitches.** To change colour smoothly start your cluster in the Yarn C but when you have your 5/4 loops left on the hook, yarn over with Yarn B and pull through all 5/4 loops on the hook to complete the stitch. When making colour changes, drop the yarn you are not using to the back of your work and pick it up again when you need it, being careful not to pull it too loose or too tight when starting with it again. You will have the tails running behind your work, but this won't be seen in the finished piece, as it will be on the inside.

This pattern is made in a spiral of continuous rounds. Place a stitch marker at the beginning of the round and move it up to the beginning stitch of each new round as you start it.

Head and upper tentacles

Head is worked from the top to the tentacles.

With Yarn A

Make a magic ring.

Rnd 1: 6sc into ring. (6sts)

Rnd 2: 2sc in each st. (12sts)

Rnd 3: *2sc in next st, sc in next st* 6 times. (18sts)

Rnd 4: *2sc in next st, sc in next 2 sts* 6 times. (24sts)

Rnd 5: *2sc in next st, sc in next 3 sts* 6 times. (30sts)

Rnd 6: *2sc in next st, sc in next 4 sts* 6 times. (36sts)

Rnd 7: *2sc in next st, sc in next 5 sts* 6 times. (42sts)

Rnd 8: *2sc in next st, sc in next 3 sts* 6 times, sc in rem 18 sts. (48sts)

Rnd 9: *2sc in next st, sc in next 7 sts* 6 times. (54sts)

Rnd 10: sc in next st, *2sc in next st, sc in next 5 sts* 6 times, sc in rem 17 sts. (60sts)

Rnd 11: *2sc in next st, sc in next 9 sts* 6 times. (66sts)

Rnd 12: sc in next 2 sts, *2sc in next st, sc in next 7 sts* 6 times, sc in rem 16 sts. (72sts)

Rnd 13 - 22: sc in each st around. (72sts)

Rnd 23: sc in next 3 sts, sc2tog, sc in next 7 sts, sc2tog, sc in next 25 sts *sc2tog, sc in next 7 sts* 3 times, sc2tog, sc in rem 4 sts. (66sts)

Rnd 24 - 25: sc in each st around. (66sts)

Rnd 26: *sc2tog, sc in next 9 sts* 6 times. (60sts)

Rnd 27 - 28: sc in each st around. (60sts)

Rnd 29: sc in next 3 sts, sc2tog, sc in next 6 sts, sc2tog, sc in next 18 sts *sc2tog, sc in next 6 sts* 3 times, sc2tog, sc in rem 3 sts. (54sts)

Rnd 30 - 31: sc in each st around. (54sts)

Start stuffing the head firmly and continue to stuff as you go.

Rnd 32: *sc2tog, sc in next 7 sts* 6 times. (48sts)

Rnd 33 - 34: sc in each st around. (48sts)

Rnd 35: sc in next 4 sts, sc2tog, sc in next 5 sts, sc2tog, sc in next 11 sts *sc2tog, sc in next 5 sts* 3 times, sc2tog, sc in rem st. (42sts)

Mark the 17th stitch of the next round with a stitch marker. This will indicate where the front of the head is and help to place the eyes later.

Rnd 36: sc in each st around. (42sts)

Rnd 37: *sc2tog, sc in next 5 sts* 6 times. (36sts)

Rnd 38: sc in next st, 2sc in next st, sc in next 5 sts, *sc2tog, sc in next 4 sts* 3 times, 2sc in next st, sc in next 5 sts, 2sc in next st, sc in rem 4 sts. (36sts)

Rnd 39: sc in next 2 sts, 2sc in next st, sc in next 4 sts, *sc2tog, sc in next 4 sts* 3 times, 2sc in next st, sc in next 5 sts, 2sc in next st, sc in rem 4 sts. (36sts)

Rnd 40: sc in next 3 sts, 2sc in next st, sc in next 4 sts, *sc2tog, sc in next 3 sts* 3 times, sc in next st, 2sc in next st, sc in next 7 sts, 2sc in next st, sc in rem 3 sts. (36sts)

Rnd 41: *sc in next 8 sts, 2sc in next st* 4 times. (40sts)

Rnd 42: sc in each st around. (40sts)

Now we will be starting the tentacles. We will continue working in the round, making a chain for each tentacle, and working down the back of the chain as we would when working a row. We will then continue in the round to the next tentacle.

Rnd 43: *sc in next 3 sts, ch31, sc into the back of the 2nd ch from hook (the skipped 1st ch becomes the 1st turning ch), sc into the back of the next 29 ch sts, sc in next 2 sts of body* 8 times. (528sts - 66sts for each tentacle, including ch sts)

Rnd 44: *sc in next 33 sts, sc into 1st turning ch, ch51, sc into the back of the 2nd ch from hook (the skipped 1st st becomes the 2nd turning ch), sc into the back of the next 49 ch sts, sc back into the 1st turning ch, sc in next 32 sts* 8 times. (1344sts - 168sts for each tentacle, including ch sts)

Using a stitch marker or scrap thread, mark the beginning stitch of every tentacle in Rnd 45 (8 markers). This will help to join the tentacle flaps later.

Rnd 45: [sc in next st, sc2tog, sc in next 62 sts, *sc in next 2 sts, 2sc in next st* 6 times, sc in next st, 2sc into 2nd turning ch, sc in next st *2sc in next st, sc in next 2 sts* 6 times, sc in next 62 sts, sc2tog.] 8 times. (1432sts - 179 sts for each tentacle)

Fasten off.

Base and underside of tentacles

The base is worked from the middle, out to the tentacles. The tentacles involve a colour change in the cluster stitches.

With Yarn A

Make a magic ring.

Rnd 1: 6sc into ring. (6sts)

Rnd 2: 2sc in each st. (12sts)

Rnd 3: *2sc in next st, sc in next st* 6 times. (18sts)

Change to Yarn B

Note: Start your colour change in the previous stitch and fasten off Yarn A.

Rnd 4: Working in the front loops of Rnd 3, sl st in each st around. (18sts)

Rnd 5: Working in the back loops of Rnd 4, *2sc in next st, sc in next 2 sts* 6 times. (24sts)

Rnd 6: *2sc in next st, sc in next 3 sts* 6 times. (30sts)

Rnd 7: *2sc in next st, sc in next 4 sts* 6 times. (36sts)

Rnd 8: *sc in next 8 sts, 2sc* 4 times. (40sts)

Rnd 9: sc in each st around. (40sts)

Now we will be starting the tentacles. We will continue working in the round, making a chain for each tentacle, and working down the back of the chain as we would when working a row. We will then continue in the round to the next tentacle.

Remember to change to Yarn C for every cluster (4dcCL/3dcCL) stitch. Switch back to Yarn B for all other stitches.

Rnd 10: *sc in next 3 sts, ch31, sc into the back of the 2nd ch from hook (the skipped 1st ch becomes the 1st turning ch), sc into the back of the next 29 ch sts, sc in next 2 sts of base* 8 times. (528sts - 66sts for each tentacle, including ch sts)

Rnd 11: [sc in next 3 sts, *sc in next 3 sts, **4dcCL*** 7 times. Fasten off Yarn C. Sc in next 2 sts, sc into 1st turning ch, ch31, sc into the back of the 2nd ch from hook (the skipped 1st ch becomes the 2nd turning ch), sc in the back of the next ch st, ***4dcCL**, sc in next 3 ch sts* 7 times, sc back into the 1st turning ch, ***4dcCL**, sc in next 3 sts* 8 times] 8 times. (1024sts - 128 sts for each tentacle, including ch sts)

Using a stitch marker or scrap thread, mark the beginning stitch of every tentacle in Rnd 12 (8 markers). This will help to join the tentacle flaps later.

Rnd 12: [sc in next st, sc2tog, sc in next 61 sts, sc in 2nd turning ch, ch26, sc into the back of the 1st ch from hook (there is no turning ch) then, ***3dcCL**, sc in next 3 ch sts,* 6 times, **3dcCL**. Fasten off yarn C. Sc back into 2nd turning ch, sc in next 61 sts, sc2tog] 8 times. (1432sts - 179 sts for each tentacle, including ch sts) Fasten off.

Tentacle flaps - make 8

The tentacle flaps start with a chain. As with the tentacles, for the flap rows we will be working up one side of the chain and back down the other. The ch1 at the end of each row is meant to add height and not included in the stitch count.

With Yarn A

Ch5.

Row 1: sc into the back of the 2nd ch from the hook, (the skipped 1st ch becomes the 1st turning ch) sc in the back of next 3 ch sts, ch1, turn. (4sts)

Row 2: 2sc in next st, sc in next 3 sts, sc into 1st turning ch, ch5, sc into the back of the 2nd ch from hook, (the skipped 1st ch becomes the 2nd turning ch) sc in the back of the next 3 ch sts, sc back into the 1st turning ch, sc in next 3 sts, 2sc in rem st, ch1, turn. (21sts, including ch sts)

Row 3: 2sc in next st, sc in next 9 sts, sc into 2nd turning ch, ch5, sc into the back of the 2nd ch from hook, (the skipped 1st ch becomes the 3rd turning ch) sc in back of next 3 ch sts, sc back into the 2nd turning ch, sc in next 9 sts, 2sc in rem st, ch1, turn. (33sts, including ch sts)

Row 4: 2sc in next st, sc in next 15 sts, sc into 3rd turning ch, sc in next 15 sts, 2sc in rem st. (35sts) Fasten off.

Joining the tentacle flaps

We will now be joining the tentacle flaps to the top and underside of the tentacles. We will do this individually for each tentacle. Place the body on top of the base so that wrong sides are facing each other. Line one of the stitch markers from the body up with a stitch marker on the base (it doesn't matter which one).

With the underside of the tentacles facing you, count 17 sts down one tentacle away from the marker on both the top and underside of the tentacles, this is your starting stitch. Place the tentacle flap upon the top of the tentacle, so that the last stitch made on the tentacle flap (where you fastened off) lines up with the starting stitch on the other two pieces.

Using Yarn A place a slip knot on your hook and with the underside facing you, work a sc st through the loops

of the underside, the top and the tentacle flap, joining them together. See Photo 1. Continue to sc 16 stitches along the tentacle side working through the underside, top and flap of the tentacles, joining them as you go until you come to the stitch markers. Remove them and continue to sc in the next 18 sts of the next tentacle working through the loops of the underside, top and flap as before. See Photo 2. (35sts)
Fasten off.
Repeat this on all eight tentacles. Stuff the base and the tentacles firmly as you go.

Joining the body, base and tentacles

We will now be joining the underside of the tentacles to the top. We will do this in one round crocheting around the edges and joining them together.

Using Yarn D, place a slip knot on your hook. With the underside of the tentacles facing you, start at the right hand side of a flap, preparing to work across the open flap edge. See the arrow marking the stitch to start in on Photo 3.

Rnd 1: *sc 8 sts across the flap, then sc through the last sc st made when joining the flaps and tentacles earlier. Continue to sc 72 stitches along the tentacle side working through both the top and underside of the tentacles, joining them as you go, until you reach the tip. Continue to sc 72 stitches along the opposite side of the tentacles back up to the flap, stopping every 10 sts to stuff the tentacle firmly as you go. Sc through the first sc st made when joining the flaps and tentacles earlier* 8 times. (1232sts - 154sts for each tentacle)
Sl st to 1st st of round and fasten off.

Eye Rings - make 2

With Yarn A

Ch2.

Rnd 1: sc into 2nd ch from hook, 5sc into ch. (6sts)

Rnd 2: 2sc in each st. (12sts)

Rnd 3: Working in the front loops only; *2sc in next st, sc in next st* 6 times. (18sts)

Rnd 4: *sc in next st, 2sc in next st, sc in next st* 6 times. (24sts)

Rnd 5: *sc in next 3 sts, 2sc in next st* 6 times. (30sts)

Rnd 6: *2sc in next st, sc in next 4 sts* 6 times. (36sts)

Rnd 7: sc in each st around. (36sts)

Rnd 8: *sc in next 4 sts, sc2tog* 6 times. (30sts)

Rnd 9: *sc2tog, sc in next 3 sts* 6 times. (24sts)

Rnd 10: *sc in next st, sc2tog, sc in next st* 6 times. (18sts)

Rnd 11: *sc2tog, sc in next st* 6 times. (12sts)

Sl st to 1st st of round and fasten off, leaving a tail to sew with. Lightly stuff the eye ring and then push the beginning rounds down toward the back hole to flatten. Flip the eye ring over and threading the yarn tail into a needle, stitch the last round to the inside of the eye ring, through the open loops left over by Rnd 3. See Photo 4. Flip the eye ring back and attach the safety eye through the space made by the beginning ch2. See Photo 5.

1st Eyelid

With Yarn A

Ch7.

Row 1: sc into 2nd ch from hook, hdc in next st, dc in next st, hdc in next st, sc in next st, sl st into last ch st. Fasten off, leaving a tail to sew with.

2nd Eyelid

With Yarn A

Ch7.

Row 1: sl st into 2nd ch from hook, sc in next st, hdc in next st, dc in next st, hdc in next st, sc in next st. Fasten off, leaving a tail to sew with.

Making Up

Stitch the eyelids onto the eye rings, making sure to curve them around the eyes.

Using the stitch marked earlier as a guide for the front of the head, place the eye rings either side of the marker so they rest 5 sts apart. Line the centres of the eyes up with the stitch marker and sew the eye rings on firmly.

We will now be making a stitch to pull in the bottom of the base. Using Yarn A, thread a needle and insert it into the middle of the base, exiting at Rnd 40 at the back of the head, then stitch back into Rnd 40, exit back at the base and pull tightly. Continue to stitch in and out of these two points and fasten off securely.

Weave in any loose ends.







